AGENT.md

One file that teaches Claude Code your repo

What does Claude read first?

AGENT.md

A Markdown brief the agent reads before it codes.

1

File per repo

Written once, read by every session

01

Anatomy

Where It Lives

```
your-repo/
├── AGENT.md
├── CLAUDE.md
├── src/
│   └── api/
├── tests/
└── docs/
```

A Working Skeleton

Setup
npm install && npm run build

Tests
npm test -- --run

Rules
- Never edit generated/

What Belongs In It

Setup commands that actually work

How to run and scope the tests

Directories that are off limits

House style the linter misses

Writing Your First One

01 Draft

Run /init in the repo

02 Correct

Fix what it guessed wrong

03 Commit

It ships with the code

Why It Pays Off

Consistent

Same rules

Faster

No discovery

Shared

Whole team

Rules Worth Writing Down

Never

Bulk-add files to a commit

Always

Run the suite before push

Regenerate

Derived files after edits

Vague Versus Usable

Vague	Usable
Write clean code	Match the file you are in
Follow best practices	Ask before adding a dep
Test your changes	pytest -q must be green

Cost of Skipping It

Every

Session relearns it

vs

Once

You write it down

AGENT.md and CLAUDE.md

AGENT.md

Vendor-neutral name

Shared across tools

One source of truth

CLAUDE.md

What Claude Code loads

Can import with @path

Or symlink to AGENT.md

"Explained it twice? Write it down."

- The test for what goes in